SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

15 July 2022 · Shift 1

67 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 33 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 23 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. He has a high paying job, _____ he never seems to have any money.

(A) yet
(B) by
(C) from
(D) so

Q.2

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. That ship has sailed

(A) To arrive early
(B) To reach safely
(C) Too late to do something
(D) Too extreme to follow

Q.3

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who has a long experience of any occupation

(A) Reverent
(B) Practitioner
(C) Staunch
(D) Veteran

Q.4

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Entirely
(B) Entierely
(C) Entierly
(D) Entyrely

Q.5

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. An agreement between enemies or opponents to stop fighting, arguing, etc., for a certain period of time

(A) Unanimous
(B) Graft
(C) Truce
(D) Surplus

Q.6

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. It feels greatly to be with you at this ceremony.

(A) at this ceremony
(B) to be with you
(C) It feels greatly
(D) No error

Q.7

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who knows all

(A) Topper
(B) Bully
(C) Anarchist
(D) Omniscient

Q.8

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Yesterday, after a nice walk, we _____ to sit on the bench, watch the birds, and rest for a while.

(A) decided
(B) decide
(C) decides
(D) deciding

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The _____ of directors will decide the penalty.

(A) bowed
(B) braid
(C) bored
(D) board

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Accuracy rates of facial recognition algorithms are _____ low in the case of minorities, women and children, as demonstrated in multiple studies across the world.

(A) smoothly
(B) Carelessly
(C) Particularly
(D) Beautifully

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I prefer to listen to relaxing and _____ music when meditating.

(A) soothing
(B) abrading
(C) fretting
(D) tormenting

Q.12

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Erring

(A) Blundering
(B) Tidy
(C) Sloppy
(D) Flawless

Q.13

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. “Carrying an umbrella” is not at all a good idea during thunderstorms.

(A) Carried an umbrella
(B) Carry an umbrella
(C) No improvement required
(D) Carrying a umbrella

Q.14

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The earthy / fragrance of soil / after a first rain / is always refreshing.

(A) is always refreshing
(B) fragrance of soil
(C) The earthy
(D) after a first rain

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The reality of the effects of rising aviation industry emissions on climate change has been known for decades, yet the industry and its emissions has continued to grow without _____.

(A) easiness
(B) neglect
(C) constraint
(D) comfort

Q.18

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Abundant

(A) Surplus
(B) Scarce
(C) Brilliant
(D) Rich

Q.19

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. He got afflicted with the disease / when he was / a teenager.

(A) No error
(B) He got afflicted with the disease
(C) a teenager
(D) when he was

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Penniless

(A) Broke
(B) Reckless
(C) Cranky
(D) Wealthy

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Anthony Abraham, a 34-year-old crane driver, (1) _____ managed to get out of the way of falling steel. Turning around, he could hardly believe the (2) _____ scene that lay before him. Girders were (3) _____ on top of the crane in a haphazard fashion, like gigantic pick up sticks. All he could see of the machine was its rear wheels and a section of what had been the cab. Abraham (4) _____ to the cab, shouting his friend George Burns' name. By then, three other iron workers had reached the (5) _____ of the carnage. One of them yelled, 'George, can you hear me?' Over the din of the diesel engine, a strained voice responded.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) substantially
(B) simultaneously
(C) barely
(D) rarely

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Anthony Abraham, a 34-year-old crane driver, (1) _____ managed to get out of the way of falling steel. Turning around, he could hardly believe the (2) _____ scene that lay before him. Girders were (3) _____ on top of the crane in a haphazard fashion, like gigantic pick up sticks. All he could see of the machine was its rear wheels and a section of what had been the cab. Abraham (4) _____ to the cab, shouting his friend George Burns' name. By then, three other iron workers had reached the (5) _____ of the carnage. One of them yelled, 'George, can you hear me?' Over the din of the diesel engine, a strained voice responded.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) criminal
(B) crooked
(C) pleasant
(D) horrible

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Anthony Abraham, a 34-year-old crane driver, (1) _____ managed to get out of the way of falling steel. Turning around, he could hardly believe the (2) _____ scene that lay before him. Girders were (3) _____ on top of the crane in a haphazard fashion, like gigantic pick up sticks. All he could see of the machine was its rear wheels and a section of what had been the cab. Abraham (4) _____ to the cab, shouting his friend George Burns' name. By then, three other iron workers had reached the (5) _____ of the carnage. One of them yelled, 'George, can you hear me?' Over the din of the diesel engine, a strained voice responded.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) dived
(B) piled
(C) duped
(D) riled

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Anthony Abraham, a 34-year-old crane driver, (1) _____ managed to get out of the way of falling steel. Turning around, he could hardly believe the (2) _____ scene that lay before him. Girders were (3) _____ on top of the crane in a haphazard fashion, like gigantic pick up sticks. All he could see of the machine was its rear wheels and a section of what had been the cab. Abraham (4) _____ to the cab, shouting his friend George Burns' name. By then, three other iron workers had reached the (5) _____ of the carnage. One of them yelled, 'George, can you hear me?' Over the din of the diesel engine, a strained voice responded.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) shoved
(B) raced
(C) halted
(D) assisted

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Anthony Abraham, a 34-year-old crane driver, (1) _____ managed to get out of the way of falling steel. Turning around, he could hardly believe the (2) _____ scene that lay before him. Girders were (3) _____ on top of the crane in a haphazard fashion, like gigantic pick up sticks. All he could see of the machine was its rear wheels and a section of what had been the cab. Abraham (4) _____ to the cab, shouting his friend George Burns' name. By then, three other iron workers had reached the (5) _____ of the carnage. One of them yelled, 'George, can you hear me?' Over the din of the diesel engine, a strained voice responded.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) sign
(B) trace
(C) scene
(D) sight

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Select the option that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. NB, OA, PZ, QY, ?

(A) RX
(B) WR
(C) RW
(D) RS

Q.3

6 persons S, O, K, U, T and A are sitting around a circular table facing towards the centre (not necessarily in the same order). S is sitting second to the right of A. Only one person is sitting between O and U. T is sitting to the immediate right of K. Only two persons are sitting between O and A. Who is sitting third to the left of K?

(A) U
(B) A
(C) S
(D) T

Q.4

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. REAS : SGDW :: ABRO : BDUS :: MOBI : ?

(A) NPEM
(B) LQEM
(C) NQEM
(D) NPDM

Q.5

There are eight persons, A, B, C, D, E, F, G and H, all having different weights. Only two persons are lighter than F. F is heavier than A but lighter than B. D is lighter than E but heavier than G. H is lighter than A. C is heavier than E. C is not the heaviest person. The weights of the second heaviest and the second lightest persons are 78 kg and 48 kg, respectively. How many persons are lighter than the person who is just lighter than D?

(A) One
(B) Three
(C) Four
(D) Two

Q.6

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All cricketers are sportspersons. Some players are sportspersons. Conclusions: I. No cricketer is a player. II. Some cricketers are players.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Only conclusion II follows
(C) Either conclusion I or II follows
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow

Q.7

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. No X is W. II. Some R are X. Conclusions: I.Some W are not X. II. No W is R.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow
(B) Only conclusion II follows
(C) Only conclusion I follows
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows

Q.8

If '–' stands for '×', '+' stands for'÷' and '÷' stands for '–', then what will be the value of 812 + 58 – 65 + 26 – 2 = ?

(A) 70
(B) 90
(C) 30
(D) 50

Q.9

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 232 : 21 :: 343 : 30 :: 157 : ?

(A) 42
(B) 33
(C) 36
(D) 39

Q.10

In a certain code language, if mustard is called fruit, fruit is called potato, potato is called burger, burger is called flower, and flower is called rice, then what is rose?

(A) potato
(B) rice
(C) flower
(D) fruit

Q.12

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 100, 98, 104, 92, 112, ?

(A) 108
(B) 82
(C) 72
(D) 64

Q.14

Which of the mathematical signs should be interchanged in the given equation to make it mathematically correct? 12 + 66 ÷ 11 – 4 × 91 = 159

(A) ÷ and ×
(B) + and –
(C) + and ×
(D) + and ÷

Q.16

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 39, 78, 117, 156, ?, 234

(A) 205
(B) 195
(C) 185
(D) 175

Q.19

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. BDF : ACE :: NPR : MOQ :: VXZ : ?

(A) UVY
(B) TUW
(C) UWY
(D) WUY

Q.20

In a certain code language, 'TIK' is coded as ‘40', 'PDM' is coded as ‘33'. How will 'RUG' be coded in that code language?

(A) 47
(B) 44
(C) 46
(D) 45

Q.21

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. KTM : PGN :: ABC : ?

(A) ZWY
(B) ZYW
(C) ZYX
(D) ZXY

Q.22

In a certain code language, 'SHAPE' is coded as 'VKDSH'. How will 'MODEL' be coded in that language?

(A) OPFGN
(B) PRGHO
(C) QRHIP
(D) CFAHW

Q.23

In a certain code language, 'ACADEMIC' is written as 'AACEDIMC', 'ABSTRACT' is written as 'ASBRTCAT', and 'ACCURACY' is written as 'ACCRUCAY'. How will 'ABACAS' be written in that language?

(A) ABCAAS
(B) AAABCS
(C) ABAACS
(D) AABACS

Q.24

Seven persons – G, M, R, K, L, P and C – are sitting around a circular table facing the centre. The following information is known about them. G is to the immediate right of K, who is third to the left of C. R is adjacent to both C and P. M is not adjacent to G. Who is third to the left of M?

(A) C
(B) L
(C) R
(D) G

Q.25

Select the option in which the two numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers in the given number-pair. 248 : 428

(A) 428 : 824
(B) 268 : 628
(C) 462 : 264
(D) 284 : 842

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Which of the following animals does NOT have a backbone?

(A) Frog
(B) Human
(C) Spider
(D) Pigeon

Q.2

According to the fundamental duties given in the Indian Constitution, it shall be the duty of every citizen of India to uphold and protect the sovereignty, _____ of India.

(A) liberty and equality
(B) unity and integrity
(C) equality and fraternity
(D) spirituality and unity

Q.3

Which of the following state governments announced a four-year mentorship programme called 'Project Arohan', to provide guidance to students and improve their skills, in February 2022?

(A) Assam
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Karnataka
(D) Himachal Pradesh

Q.4

The remains of the dead plants and animals trapped in the layers of rocks are called _____.

(A) manures
(B) moulds
(C) fossils
(D) remnants

Q.5

Who won the men's singles title in Australian Open 2022?

(A) Rafael Nadal
(B) Stefanos Tsitsipas
(C) Matteo Berrettini
(D) Daniil Medvedev

Q.6

What is speed?

(A) It is the distance covered by an object in a unit time.

(B) It is the velocity of an object per unit time.

(C) It is the force applied on covering a unit distance.

(D) It is the acceleration of an object per unit time.

Q.7

The Census of India provides us with information regarding _____.

(A) industrial production

(B) pollution

(C) food security

(D) the population

Q.8

Which of the following financial institutions of India protects the interests of the investors and facilitates the functioning of the stock market intermediaries?

(A) Small Industries Development Bank of India(SIDBI)

(B) India Infrastructure Finance Company Ltd (IIFCL)

(C) National Housing Bank (NHB)

(D) Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)

Q.9

Which of the following novels is based on the Member of Parliament (India), Phoolan devi, and written by the author Roy Moxham?

(A) Outlaw: India's Bandit Queen and Me

(B) Lilavati's Daughters

(C) Spy Princess

(D) The Woman Who Knew Infinity

Q.10

Ustad Allarakha Qureshi, also known as Alla Rakha, was associated with which musical instrument?

(A) Piano

(B) Tabla

(C) Sarod

(D) Flute

Q.11

Where does the Eastern Coastal Plain of India lie?

(A) Between Diu and Kerala

(B) Between the Eastern Ghats and the Bay of Bengal

(C) Between the Gulf of Cambay and Cape Comorin

(D) Between Maharashtra and Kerala

Q.12

Which of the following persons was appointed as the Commissioner of Delhi Police in July 2021?

(A) Kiran Bedi

(B) Rakesh Asthana

(C) Athar Aamir Khan

(D) Tina Dabi

Q.13

The _____ is an Act of the Parliament of the United Kingdom that partitioned British India into two new independent dominions of India and Pakistan in 1947.

(A) Industrial Disputes Act

(B) Government of India Act

(C) Indian Independence Act

(D) Rowlatt Act

Q.14
In which year did Babur defeat Rana Sanga at Khanua?

(A) 1531
(B) 1527
(C) 1529
(D) 1525

Q.15
Ancient Harappan site 'Lothal' was found in which state of India?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Rajasthan
(C) Maharashtra
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Q.16
With which of the following Indian classical dance forms was T Balasaraswati associated?

(A) Kathak
(B) Kathakali
(C) Bharatanatyam
(D) Manipuri

Q.17
In which year did Mahatma Gandhi first introduce a nationwide satyagraha in India?

(A) 1915
(B) 1921
(C) 1919
(D) 1916

Q.18
Recommended Dietary Allowances = ?

(A) Balanced diet – Extra nutrients
(B) Requirements + Margin of safety
(C) Extra nutrients
(D) Intermittent fasting + Extra nutrients

Q.19
Which of the following sports was NOT played at the 2020 Summer Olympic Games (played in 2021)?

(A) Cricket
(B) Shooting
(C) Football
(D) Hockey

Q.20
As of April 2022, amongst others, Legislative Councils are present in the states of _____.

(A) Meghalaya, Punjab and Goa
(B) Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and Maharashtra
(C) Chhattisgarh, Delhi and Goa
(D) Tamil Nadu, West Bengal and Gujarat

Q.21
Who among the following was the founder of the Shunga Dynasty (185 BC - 73 BC)?

(A) Bhagabhadra
(B) Agnimitra
(C) Vasumitra
(D) Pushyamitra

Q.22
Which famous Indian Kathak dancer received the 'Padma Vibhushan' in 1986?

(A) Rukmini Devi Arundale
(B) Mallika Sarabhai
(C) Guru Bipin Singh
(D) Pandit Birju Maharaj

Q.23
The Festival of Salhesh is celebrated in the state of:

(A) Tamil Nadu
(B) Punjab
(C) Gujarat
(D) Bihar

Q.24

When was the latest census conducted in India?

(A) 2021
(B) 2005
(C) 2001
(D) 2011

Q.25

Which of the following neighbours of India has the highest population density?

(A) Bangladesh
(B) Sri Lanka
(C) China
(D) Pakistan

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**
Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**	

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(C)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (A) yet

'Yet' joins two clauses that contrast: he earns well but never seems to have money. 'So' would introduce a result, and 'by' and 'from' are prepositions.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Too late to do something

'That ship has sailed' means the chance has gone: it is too late to do something about it.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Veteran

A veteran is a person with long experience in a field or occupation. A practitioner simply practises a profession, 'reverent' means showing deep respect and 'staunch' means loyal.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Entirely

The correct spelling is 'entirely': 'entire' plus '-ly'.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Truce

A truce is an agreement between opponents to stop fighting for a time. 'Unanimous' means all agreeing, 'graft' is bribery or hard work, and a surplus is an excess.

Q.6 · Answer (C) It feels greatly

'Feel' is a linking verb here, so it takes an adjective, not an adverb: 'It feels great to be with you at this ceremony.'

Q.7 · Answer (D) Omniscient

'Omniscient' means knowing everything (from the Latin for 'all' and 'knowing'). An anarchist rejects all government.

Q.8 · Answer (A) decided

'Yesterday' places the action in the past, so the simple past 'decided' is needed.

Q.9 · Answer (D) board

A company is run by its 'board of directors'. 'Bored', which sounds the same, means weary, and 'bowed' and 'braid' make no sense here.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Particularly

'Particularly' (especially) shows that the accuracy is low for these groups above all. 'Smoothly', 'carelessly' and 'beautifully' make no sense with 'low'.

Q.11 · Answer (A) soothing

'Soothing' means calming, which goes with 'relaxing' and with meditation. 'Abrading', 'fretting' and 'tormenting' suggest irritation or pain.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Blundering

'Erring' means making mistakes: 'blundering'. 'Flawless' is its opposite.

Q.13 · Answer (C) No improvement required

A gerund phrase can be the subject of a sentence, and 'umbrella' begins with a vowel sound, so 'an' is right: 'Carrying an umbrella is not at all a good idea' needs no change.

Q.14 · Answer (D) after a first rain

An ordinal such as 'first' takes the definite article: 'after the first rain'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) constraint

To grow 'without constraint' is to grow without limit or restriction, which is the point of the 'yet' clause. 'Neglect', 'easiness' and 'comfort' make no sense here.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Scarce

'Abundant' means plentiful, so its opposite is 'scarce'. 'Surplus' and 'rich' are close to its meaning.

Q.19 · Answer (A) No error
The sentence is correct: one is 'afflicted with' a disease, and 'when he was a teenager' keeps the past tense.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Broke
'Penniless' means having no money: 'broke'. 'Wealthy' is its opposite.

Q.21 · Answer (C) barely
He 'barely' managed to get out of the way, that is he only just escaped the falling steel.

Q.22 · Answer (D) horrible
The wreck of the crane under the fallen girders was a 'horrible' scene, one he could hardly believe.

Q.23 · Answer (B) piled
Girders lying 'in a haphazard fashion, like gigantic pick up sticks' were 'piled' on top of the crane.

Q.24 · Answer (B) raced
Shouting his friend's name, he 'raced', that is ran fast, to the cab. 'Halted' would mean he stopped.

Q.25 · Answer (C) scene
The 'scene' of the carnage is the place where it happened. 'Sight' sounds like 'site' but means something seen.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (A) RX
The first letters move forward one (N, O, P, Q, R) and the second letters back one (B, A, Z, Y, X): RX.

Q.3 · Answer (A) U
Facing the centre, right is anticlockwise. O sits opposite A (two persons between them) and S second to A's right; the only arrangement that fits the other clues is, anticlockwise from A: A, U, S, O, K, T. Third to the left of K is U.

Q.4 · Answer (C) NQEM
The four letters move +1, +2, +3 and +4: REAS → SGDW and ABRO → BDUS. So MOBI → NQEM.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Three
Only H and A are lighter than F, so from the lightest the order begins H, A, F. G < D < E < C, and as C is not the heaviest, B is: H, A, F, G, D, E, C, B. The person just lighter than D is G, and three persons (H, A, F) are lighter than G.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Either conclusion I or II follows
Neither conclusion is certain, as the players who are sportspersons need not be cricketers. But 'No cricketer is a player' and 'Some cricketers are players' form a complementary pair, one of which must be true, so either I or II follows.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Only conclusion I follows
'No X is W' means that no W is X either, so some W are not X: I follows. The R that are X are not W, but other R may be W, so II does not follow.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 70
After replacing the signs: 812 ÷ 58 × 65 ÷ 26 × 2 = 14 × 65 ÷ 26 × 2 = 910 ÷ 26 × 2 = 35 × 2 = 70.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 39
The second number is three times the sum of the first number's digits: (2 + 3 + 2) × 3 = 21 and (3 + 4 + 3) × 3 = 30. So (1 + 5 + 7) × 3 = 39.

Q.10 · Answer (B) rice
A rose is a flower, and a flower is called 'rice' in this code.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 82
The differences are −2, +6, −12, +20, −30, that is 1 × 2, 2 × 3, 3 × 4, 4 × 5 and 5 × 6 with alternating signs: 112 − 30 = 82.

Q.14 · Answer (C) + and ×
After interchanging + and ×: 12 × 66 ÷ 11 − 4 + 91 = 12 × 6 − 4 + 91 = 72 − 4 + 91 = 159.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 195
The terms are 39 × 1, 39 × 2, 39 × 3 and 39 × 4, so the fifth is 39 × 5 = 195 (and the sixth 39 × 6 = 234).

Q.19 · Answer (C) UWY
Each letter moves back one: BDF → ACE and NPR → MOQ. So VXZ → UWY.

Q.20 · Answer (C) 46
Each code is the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet: TIK = 20 + 9 + 11 = 40 and PDM = 16 + 4 + 13 = 33. So RUG = 18 + 21 + 7 = 46.

Q.21 · Answer (C) ZYX
Each letter is replaced by its opposite in the alphabet (their places add up to 27): K → P, T → G and M → N. So ABC → ZYX.

Q.22 · Answer (B) PRGHO
Each letter moves forward three places: SHAPE → VKDSH. So MODEL → PRGHO.

Q.23 · Answer (D) AABACS
The first and last letters stay and the letters between are swapped in pairs: A CA DE MI C → A AC ED IM C. So A BA CA S → A AB AC S: AABACS.

Q.24 · Answer (A) C
Facing the centre, right is anticlockwise. Anticlockwise from K the order is K, G, L, C, R, P, M: G is immediately right of K, C third to K's right, R between C and P, and M, not beside G, in the last seat. Moving to M's left the seats are P, R and then C, so C is third to M's left.

Q.25 · Answer (B) 268 : 628
The first two digits swap places: 248 → 428. Likewise 268 → 628.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Spider
A spider is an arthropod, an invertebrate with a hard outer covering instead of a backbone. Frogs, humans and pigeons are vertebrates.

Q.2 · Answer (B) unity and integrity
Article 51A(c) makes it a fundamental duty 'to uphold and protect the sovereignty, unity and integrity of India'.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Assam
Assam's AROHAN, a mentor-mentee scheme of the state government for meritorious students of its government schools, guides them from Class IX to Class XII; it began in 2022-23.

Q.4 · Answer (C) fossils
Fossils are the remains or traces of plants and animals preserved in layers of rock, mostly sedimentary rock.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Rafael Nadal
Rafael Nadal beat Daniil Medvedev in the final of the 2022 Australian Open, coming back from two sets down, for his 21st Grand Slam singles title.

Q.6 · Answer (A) It is the distance covered by an object in a unit time.
Speed is the distance an object covers in unit time, for example metres per second. Velocity is speed in a given direction.

Q.7 · Answer (D) the population
The Census of India counts the population and records its features, such as age, sex, literacy and occupation, once every ten years.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is the regulator of the securities market: it protects investors' interests and registers and regulates intermediaries such as stockbrokers.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Outlaw: India’s Bandit Queen and Me
Roy Moxham's 'Outlaw: India's Bandit Queen and Me' (2010), a memoir rather than a novel, tells of his friendship with Phoolan Devi, which began with a letter he wrote to her in jail in 1992.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Tabla
Ustad Alla Rakha, father of Zakir Hussain, was a tabla maestro, known for accompanying the sitarist Ravi Shankar.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Between the Eastern Ghats and the Bay of Bengal
The Eastern Coastal Plain lies between the Eastern Ghats and the Bay of Bengal. The other options describe stretches of the western coast.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Rakesh Asthana
Rakesh Asthana, then Director General of the Border Security Force, was appointed Commissioner of Delhi Police on 27 July 2021.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Indian Independence Act
The Indian Independence Act, 1947, passed by the British Parliament in July 1947, created the dominions of India and Pakistan from 15 August 1947.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 1527
Babur defeated Rana Sanga of Mewar at Khanua, near Fatehpur Sikri, in March 1527.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Gujarat
Lothal, a Harappan port town known for its dockyard, is in Ahmedabad district, Gujarat.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Bharatanatyam
T Balasaraswati (1918-1984) was a leading Bharatanatyam dancer, from a hereditary family of performers in Tamil Nadu.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 1919
The Rowlatt Satyagraha of 1919, against the Rowlatt Act, was Gandhi's first nationwide satyagraha; his earlier ones, at Champaran (1917), Kheda and Ahmedabad (1918), were local.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Requirements + Margin of safety
Recommended Dietary Allowances are set above the average requirement of each nutrient, with a margin of safety added to cover differences between individuals, so that nearly everyone's needs are met.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Cricket
Cricket was not on the programme of the Tokyo 2020 Games; shooting, football and hockey were. When the exam was held (July 2022), cricket had been played at the Olympics only once, at Paris in 1900.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and Maharashtra
In April 2022 six states had a Legislative Council: Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana and Uttar Pradesh. None of the states in the other options had one, and Delhi is not a state.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Pushyamitra
Pushyamitra Shunga, commander of the last Mauryan king Brihadratha, killed him and founded the Shunga dynasty. Agnimitra was his son, and Vasumitra and Bhagabhadra were later kings of the line.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Pandit Birju Maharaj
Pandit Birju Maharaj of the Lucknow gharana of Kathak received the Padma Vibhushan in 1986. Rukmini Devi Arundale is known for Bharatanatyam, Mallika Sarabhai for Kuchipudi and Bharatanatyam, and Guru Bipin Singh for Manipuri.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Bihar

The festival of Raja Salhesh, the folk hero and deity of the Dusadh community, is held in the Mithila region of Bihar, with rituals, songs and dance-drama telling his story.

Q.24 · Answer (D) 2011

When the exam was held (July 2022) the latest census was that of 2011; the census due in 2021 had been postponed because of the Covid-19 pandemic.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Bangladesh

Bangladesh, with more than 1,100 people per square kilometre, is among the most densely populated countries in the world, several times denser than Sri Lanka, Pakistan or China.

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